ARTIST PROTOCOL

Fine Line & Micro Tattoo

Light hand, shallow depth. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake, ID and fine-line consent signed. Not intoxicated, pregnant or breastfeeding.

PLACEMENT & SIZE

Hands, fingers, feet and ribs blur or fade faster. Advise a minimum size of [ ] in.

SKIN CHECK

Thin, soft or sun-damaged skin blows out easily. Moles: work around, never over.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use 1RL–3RL ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	10 min	Review intake, ID and meds. Explain blur, fading and touch-up odds.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open single-needle cartridges in front of client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Keep the skin dry.
4	**Stencil & approval**	10 min	Fine, clean stencil. Client checks size, placement and spelling; initials.
5	**Test line**	2 min	Short line inside the design to judge depth and how the skin gives.
6	**Lining**	[ ] min	Low voltage, slow steady hand, firm stretch. One pass where possible.
7	**Soft shading**	[ ] min	Light whip or stipple. Don't stack passes; stop if the skin puffs up.
8	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Dab gently, never scrub. Check for blowout or uneven lines. Photos.
9	**Wrap**	5 min	Very thin ointment, or second-skin film as agreed.
10	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Little ointment, strict sun care. Touch-up check at [6–8] weeks.
11	**Breakdown & record**	10 min	Sharps, waste, surfaces. Log needle size, voltage, inks and lot #.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Crisp, even lines; no blowout halo
- Client told a touch-up is often needed
- Minimal trauma: one pass, light hand
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Blowout appears: stop deepening that line. Note it and reassess after healing.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Lines skipping on hands or feet: don't overwork. Book a touch-up once healed.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Needle (1RL–3RL)	Machine · voltage
Placement · size	**Numbing product**	**Blowout noted?**	**Time · initials**